



Ten Essentials Checklist

Carry all 10 systems, every trip.

THE TEN ESSENTIAL SYSTEMS — CARRY ALL 10, EVERY TRIP

- 1 Navigation Topo map + compass + GPS/phone with offline maps. Know how to use them all.
- 2 Headlamp LED headlamp + extra batteries. Test before every trip. Hands-free light.
- 3 Sun Protection SPF 30+ sunscreen, UV sunglasses, hat, lip balm with SPF. Reapply every 2 hrs.
- 4 First Aid Kit Bandages, gauze, tape, pain meds, blister care, personal meds. Check dates.
- 5 Knife + Repair Multi-tool, duct tape (3+ ft), cord/paracord (50 ft), zip ties, safety pins.
- 6 Fire Starting Waterproof matches AND lighter + fire starter. Both — redundancy matters.
- 7 Emergency Shelter Bivy, space blanket, or ultralight tarp. Practice setup at home first.
- 8 Extra Food 1+ extra day's worth. Bars, nuts, jerky, peanut butter. No cooking required.
- 9 Extra Water 1L+ extra + purification (filter, tablets, or UV). Pre-hydrate before hike.
- 10 Extra Clothing Insulating layer, rain jacket + pants, warm hat, gloves. NO COTTON.

FIELD TIPS

- Total weight: A complete kit weighs only 3-5 lbs. There is no excuse to skip it.
- Cotton kills: Loses ALL insulation when wet. Wool or synthetic materials only.
- Cold batteries: Lose 20-40% capacity in cold. Keep phone and headlamp in inside pockets.
- Pre-hydrate: Drink 16 oz in the hour before you start. Dark urine = already dehydrated.
- Keep it packed: Dedicated bag, always ready to grab. Check expiration dates each season.

MOST RESCUES INVOLVE DAY HIKERS The majority of people we rescue planned to be out for 'just a few hours.' Afternoon weather, a wrong turn, or a minor injury can turn a short hike into an overnight. Always pack as if you might spend the night out. Pierce County spans sea level to 14,411 ft (Mt. Rainier) — prepare for the highest point on your route.